

Industry Cafe & Jazz

Sequined pants sparkle across the floor,
Spins and shimmies
Sprinkled into the waitress's strut.
She side steps through swaying patrons
And my nose follows,
A swirl of koseret and cinnamon
Engulfing me
While the sax sound grows.

His solo gives glimpses of Gaia,
Grit and growl in notes
Grazing the ground,
High notes gliding through the air
Like gulls over a glistening sea,
A bouncy groove guiding our giddiness
Until he passes his part to the guitar.

Playful licks plucked along strings
Put together pieces of the tenor's tune.
He walks with the punchy bass,
Two pals on a shared path
Stepping in parallel at
Just the perfect pace,
When a new companion appears,
A mouth full of pearly whites and
A head of puffy hair.

Krar in happy hand,
Homeland and heart on stage,
He hails us so
We hoot and we holler,
We sing "shalalala"—
Our hoard of voices as one whole,
Held up by each hit of the drum.

Bless the builder
Who *tap tap tapped* against all four corners
Steady as the *ting ting ting* of the cymbal,
For I was sure the cafe would come
Crashing down
With song and applause and whistle and
Life
Bursting through these unassuming walls.
When the crowd eventually calms,
My music goes on.

You giggle with melodies
Greater than Goodwin's and
You pat my palm with rhythms
That humble Hanna.
The golden lights
Glitter on your glasses and
If I squinted, I could swear
They are the stars I see in your eyes.
In my periphery, your rapping pinky alone
Glow with life galore;
In my sight's center, your sweet smile
Holds *my* whole life, and more.